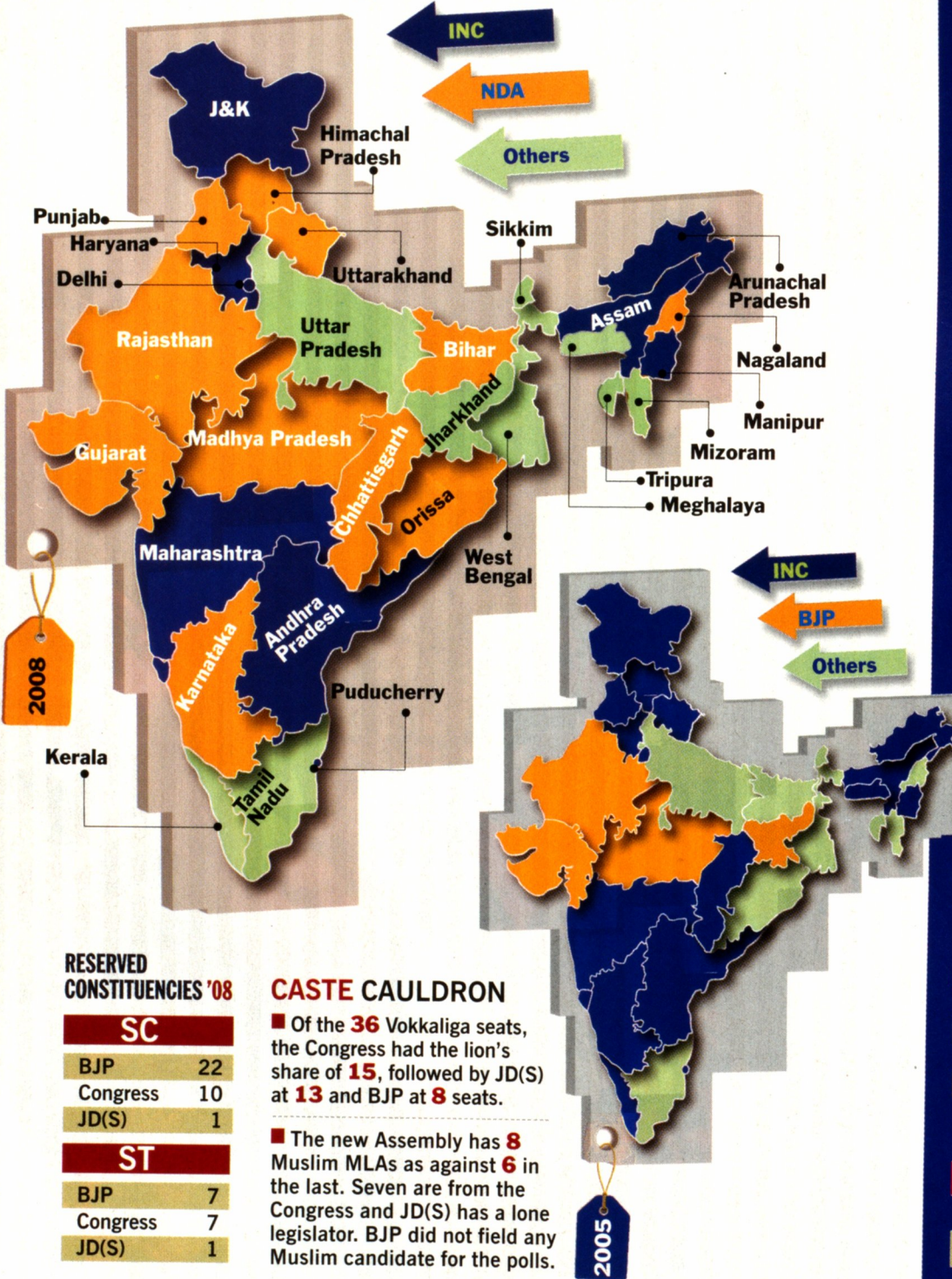


CHANGING COLOURS OF INCREDIBLE POLITICAL INDIA

Since 2005, the Congress has lost 12 Assembly elections while BJP and its allies have won in seven states. In the face of mounting defeats, the Congress has no option but to revise its strategy to come up with a winning formula.

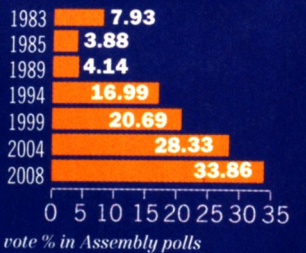


NUMBERS GAME

■ In the cow belt which sends **233** Lok Sabha members, the UPA rules in three tiny states of Delhi, Haryana and J&K. The NDA rules big states like MP, Rajasthan, Punjab and Bihar.

■ BJP has **940** MLAs, Congress **656**, excluding Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and the North-east where BJP has no presence.

Karnataka BJP Rapid Rise



■ Of the **81** Lingayats who won, **45** came from BJP, the highest; **26** from the Congress and **10** from JD(S). BJP alone fielded **71** Lingayat candidates and **45** of them won in north Karnataka districts like Gadag, Haveri, Raichur and Davanagere.

Karnataka 2008

Party	Seats
BJP	110
Congress	80
JD(S)	28
Independents	6

Vote Share (%)

	2004	2008
BJP	28.5	33.86
Congress	35.3	34.59
JD(S)	20.6	19.12

RESERVED CONSTITUENCIES '08

SC	
BJP	22
Congress	10
JD(S)	1
ST	
BJP	7
Congress	7
JD(S)	1

CASTE CAULDRON

■ Of the **36** Vokkaliga seats, the Congress had the lion's share of **15**, followed by JD(S) at **13** and BJP at **8** seats.

■ The new Assembly has **8** Muslim MLAs as against **6** in the last. Seven are from the Congress and JD(S) has a lone legislator. BJP did not field any Muslim candidate for the polls.

BJP'S ACQUISITION OF A BRAND NEW LEADER IS THE MOST DEFINITIVE OUTCOME OF

Graphic by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY